

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1987-06-28

1 dear bahá'í friends,
2 your letter of 25 may 1987 concerning mr. . . . has been received by the
3 universal house of justice, which has directed us to reply as follows.
4 in considering the status of believers such as mr. . . . , it is necessary
5 to review the requirements for membership in the bahá'í community. The
6 basic considerations are set out by the guardian in his statement:

. . . i would only venture to state very briefly and as adequately as

7 present circumstances permit the principal factors that must be taken into
consideration before deciding whether a person may be regarded a true believer or not. full
recognition of the station of the forerunner,

the Author, and the True exemplar of the bahá'í cause, as set forth

in 'Abdu'l-bahá's Testament; unreserved acceptance of, and submission to,

8 sion to, whatsoever has been revealed by their pen; loyal and steadfast

adherence to every clause of our beloved's sacred will; and close as-

9 sociation with the spirit as well as the form of the present day bahá'í

administration throughout the world—these i conceive to be the fun-

10 damental and primary considerations that must be fairly, discreetly and thoughtfully
ascertained before reaching such a vital decision. . . .

(Bahá'í Administration, p. 90, october 2, 1925)32.1

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33 me Sage S from The universal house of justice

34 ing the issue of acceptance of new believers, when it wrote:

Those who declare themselves as bahá'ís should become en-

chanted with the beauty of the teachings, and touched by the love

35 of bahá'u'lláh. The declarants need not know all the proofs, history,

36 laws, and principles of the faith, but in the process of declaring them-
37 selves they must, in addition to catching the spark of faith, become basically informed
about the central figures of the faith, as well as

the existence of laws they must follow and an administration they

38 must obey.

39 (from a letter to all National Spiritual Assemblies, 1 j uly 196)32-1

40 it follows that individuals who do not satisfy these requirements cannot

be regarded as members of the bahá'í community, irrespective of what-

41 ever statements they might make concerning the nature of their belief in
42 bahá'u'lláh. Such a situation arises, in some instances, when a person claims
43 to accept the station of bahá'u'lláh but does not accept the authority of the
44 Administrative institutions. The guardian clarified this matter in a letter
45 written on his behalf, stating:

46 . . . To accept the cause without the administration is like to accept
47 the teachings without acknowledging the divine station of bahá'u'lláh.

To be a bahá'í is to accept the cause in its entirety. To take excep-

48 tion to one basic principle is to deny the authority and sovereignty of bahá'u'lláh, and
therefore is to deny the cause. . . .

(letter to a National Spiritual Assembly, 0 m ay 190)

49 if you feel that mr. . . . does not accept "the authority and sovereignty
50 of bahá'u'lláh" as explained above, despite the statements he might make
51 asserting his acceptance of the bahá'í faith, you should remove his name
52 from the list of members and regard him as being a non-b ahá'í.
53 if you feel that the continued association of the bahá'ís with mr. . . . is
54 potentially damaging to their belief or is detrimental to the unity of the
55 community, you could well consider advising the believers to avoid associa-
56 tion with him.

57 32-1. See muhj, no. 18.32.2b

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6The house of justice advises you to deal with this matter in a straightfor-

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ward way, avoiding any actions which might serve to increase mr. . . .’s sense

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of his own importance or which might needlessly antagonize him and hence

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provoke him into active opposition of the i nstitutions.

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The house of justice will offer its prayers at the Sacred Threshold for

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your guidance in resolving this matter.

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with loving b ahá’í greetings,

Department of tHe secretariat

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Functioning of an Executive Committee

of a National Spiritual Assembly

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]